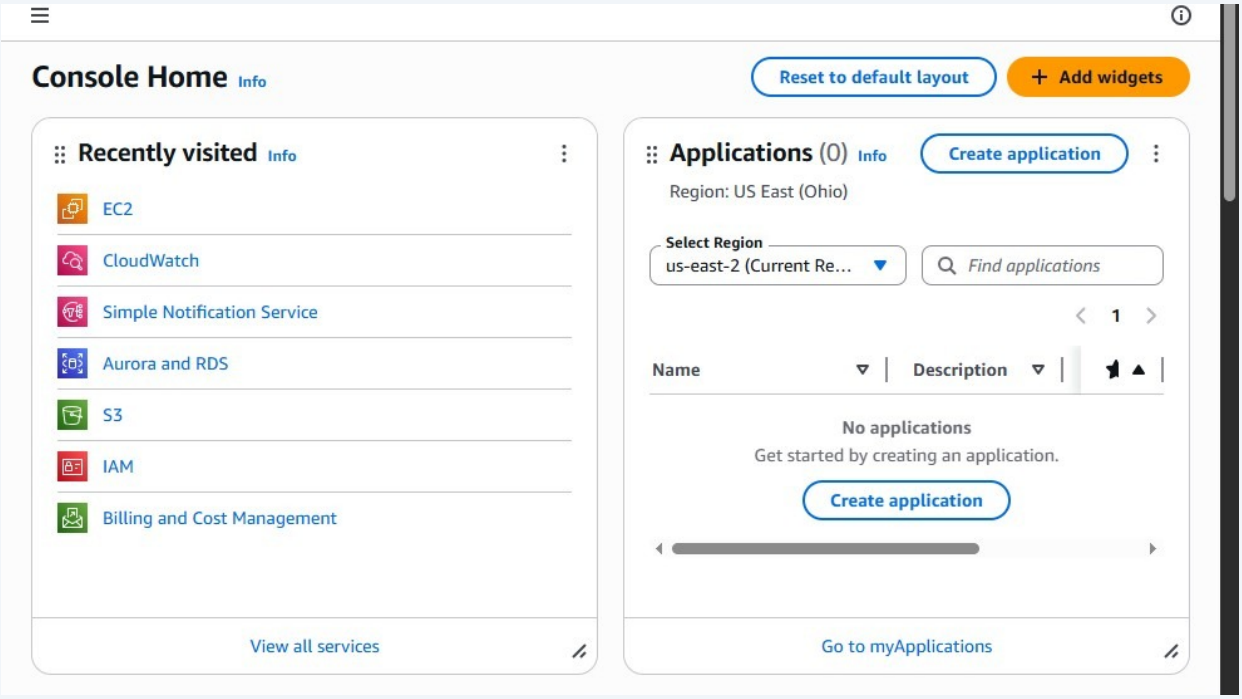
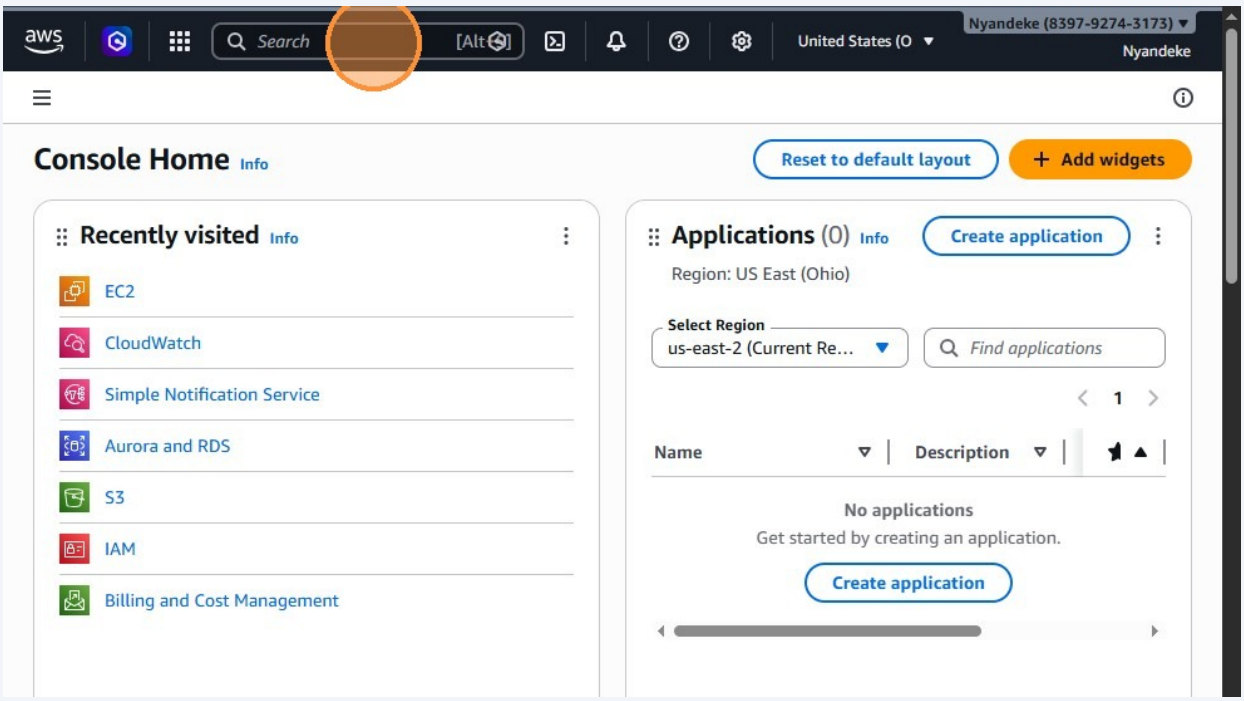
Launch and Stop Your First EC2 Instance

Learn how to launch and then stop your very first EC2 instance. This guide walks you through the essential steps to get your virtual server up and running and then safely shut it down.

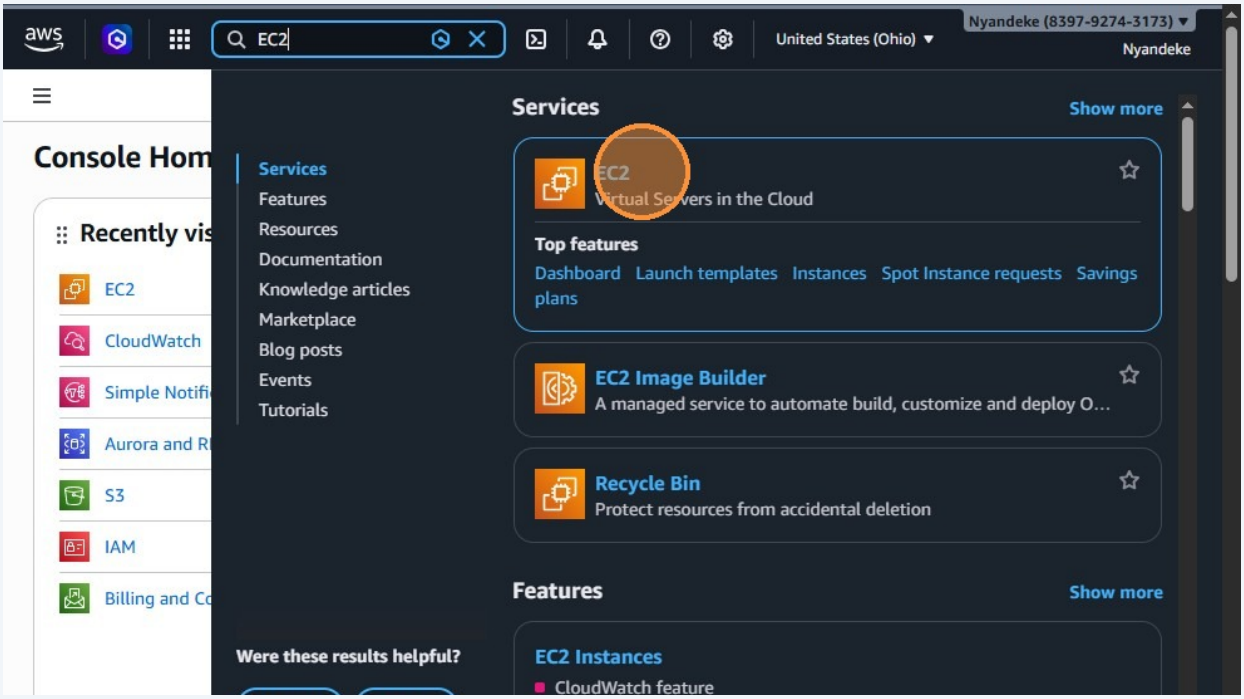
1 Navigate tohttps://aws.amazon.com/free/ where you will either create an account or sign-in, you will sign in as a root user where you will be taken to this page the "Console Management".



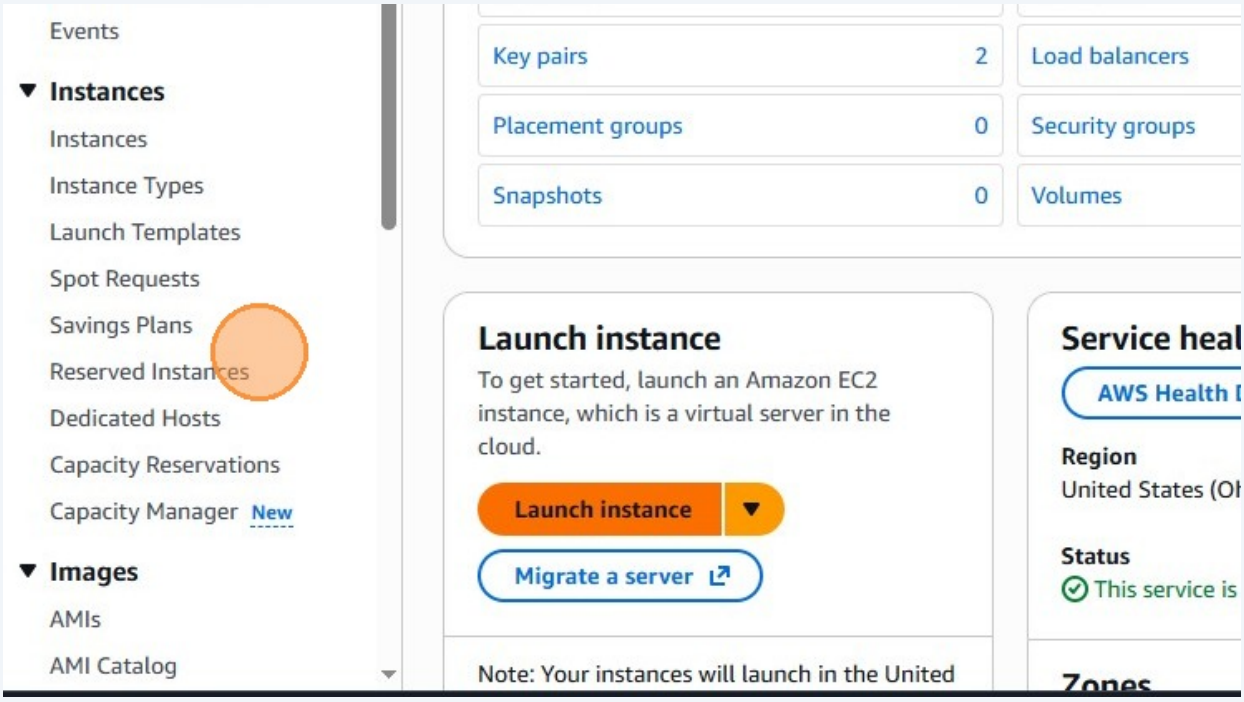
2 on this page click the "Search" field, especially as a new user as the recently visited section will still be empty unlike on my page.



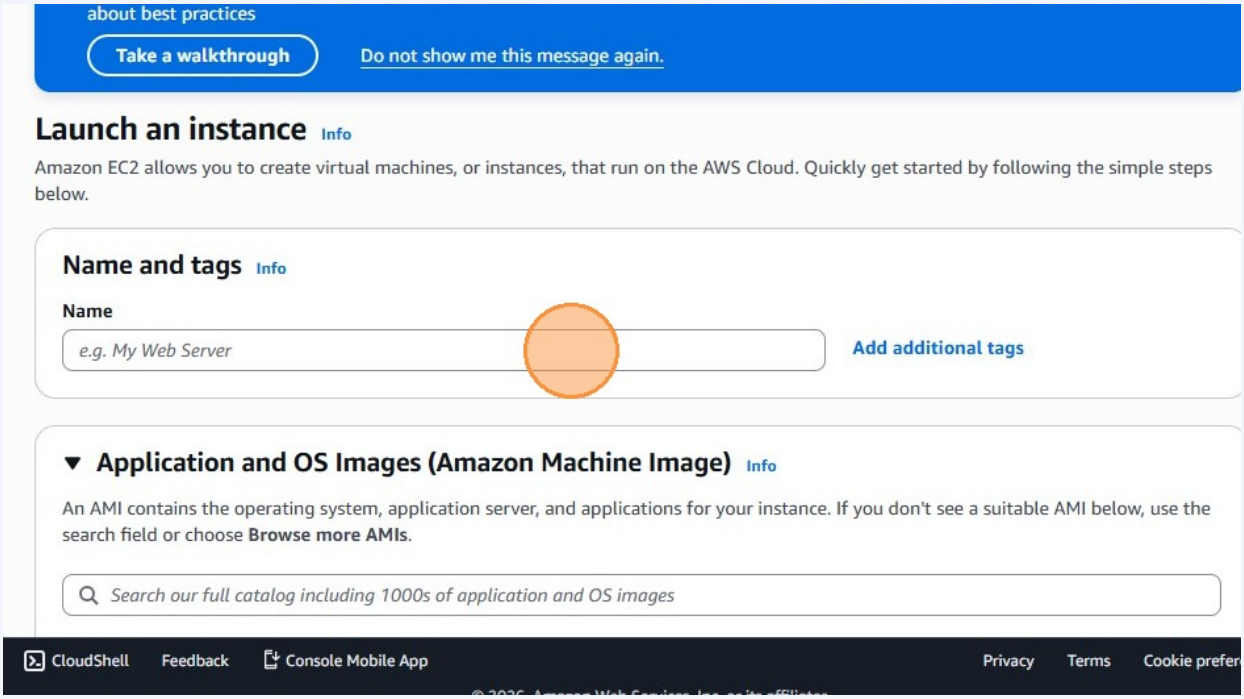
3 Type then afterward select "EC2" on the search field



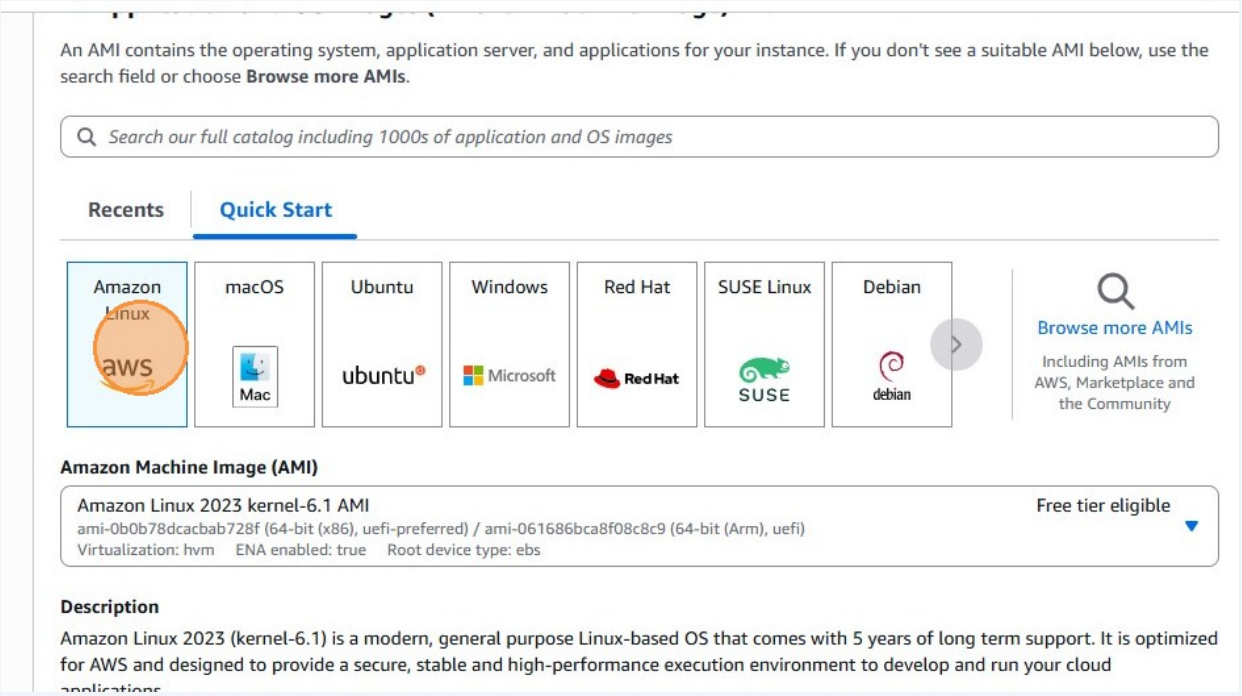
4 Click "Launch instance"



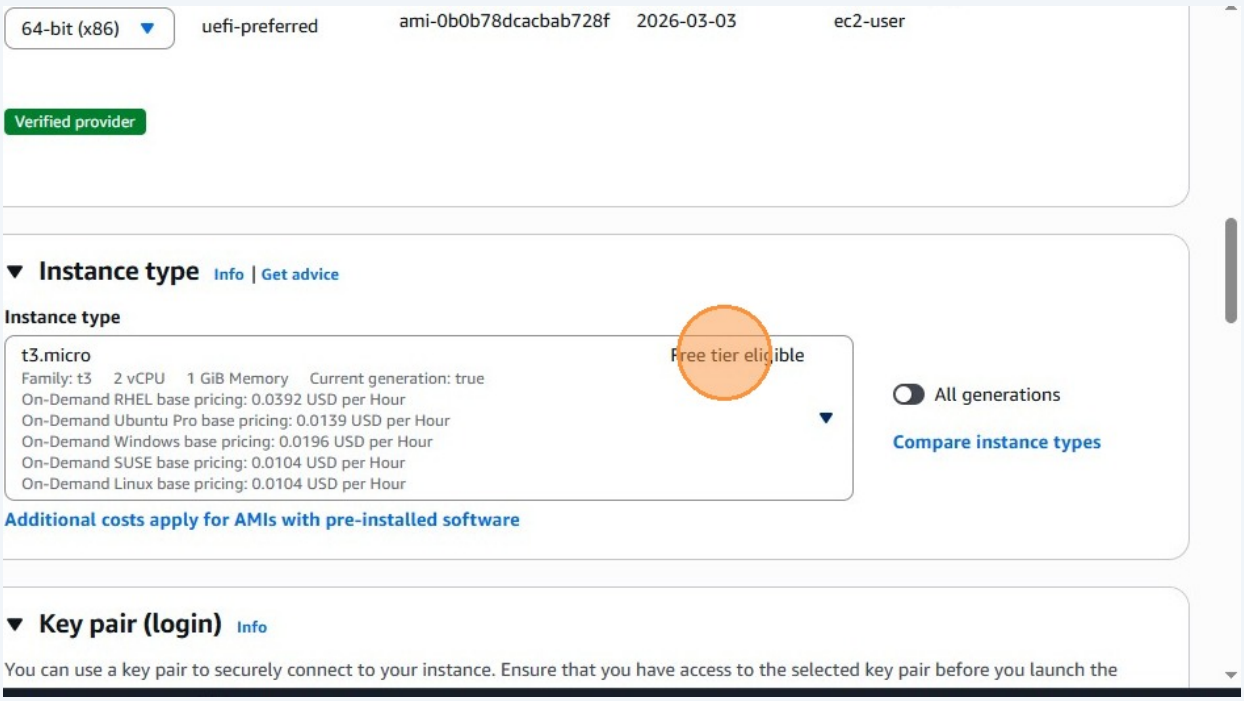
5 Edit the "Name" of your instance, I named mine "My first Instance".



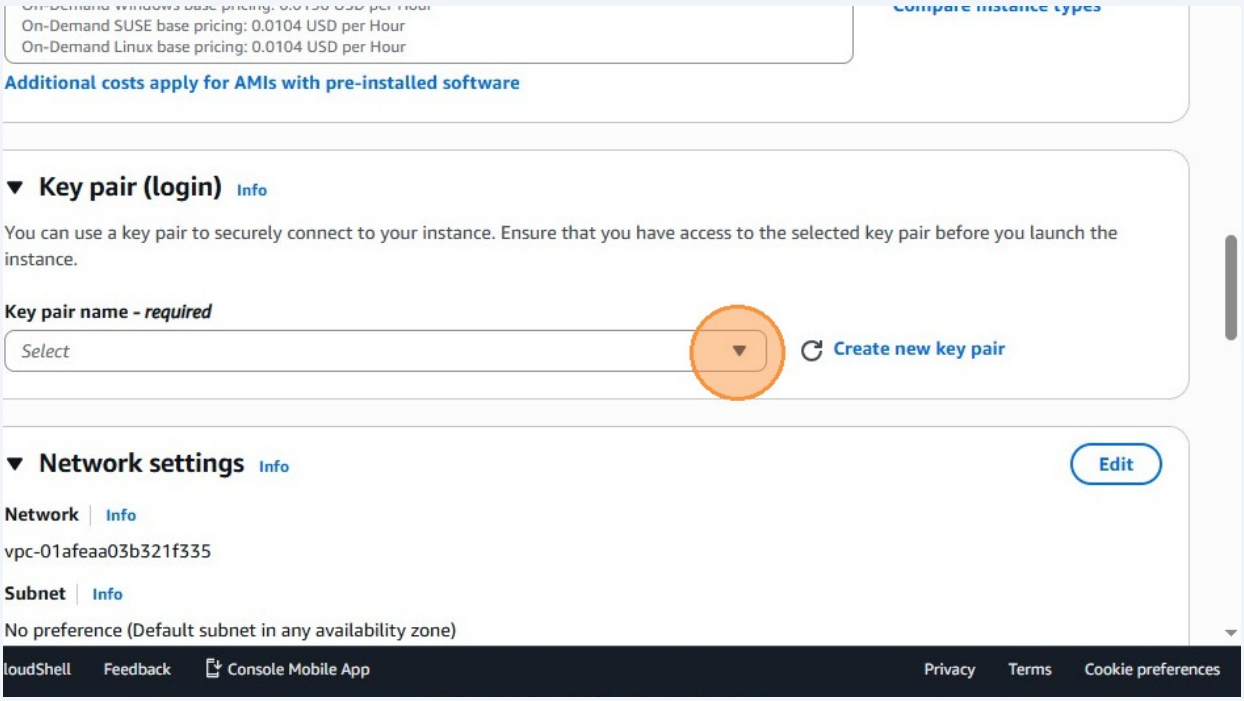
6 Select the image of your choice, I went with Amazon Linux.



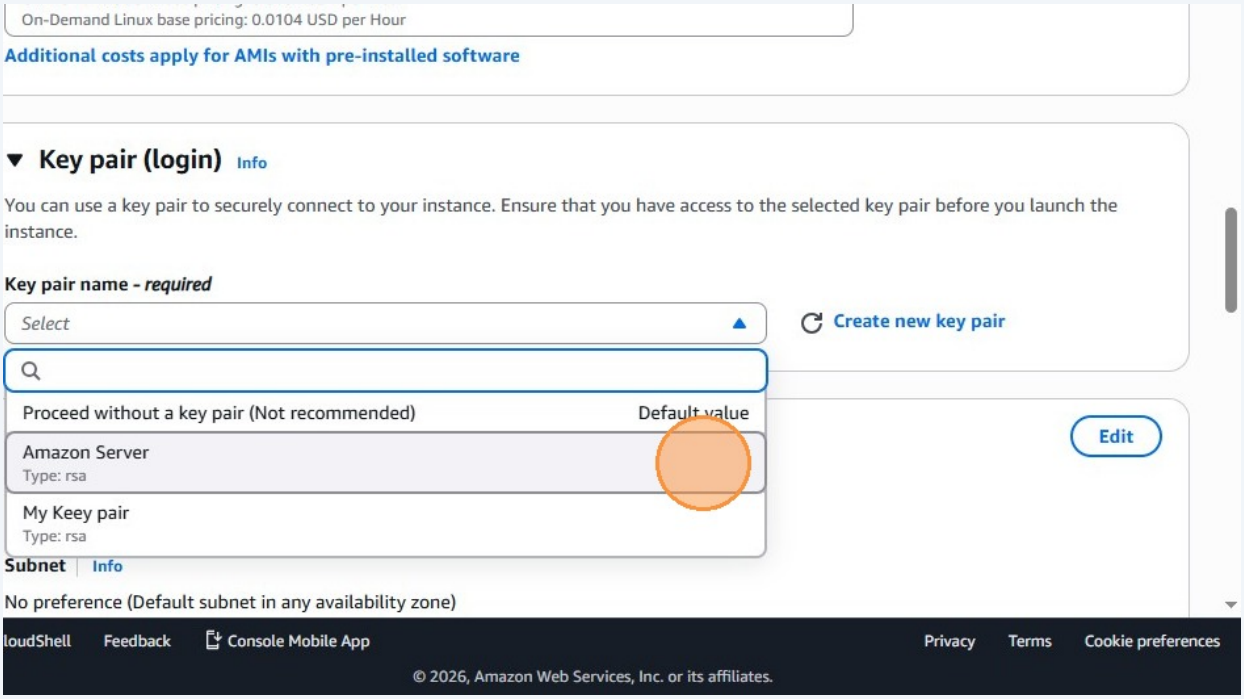
7 Choose your Instance type. We selected "Free tier eligible" because we are using a free-tier account.



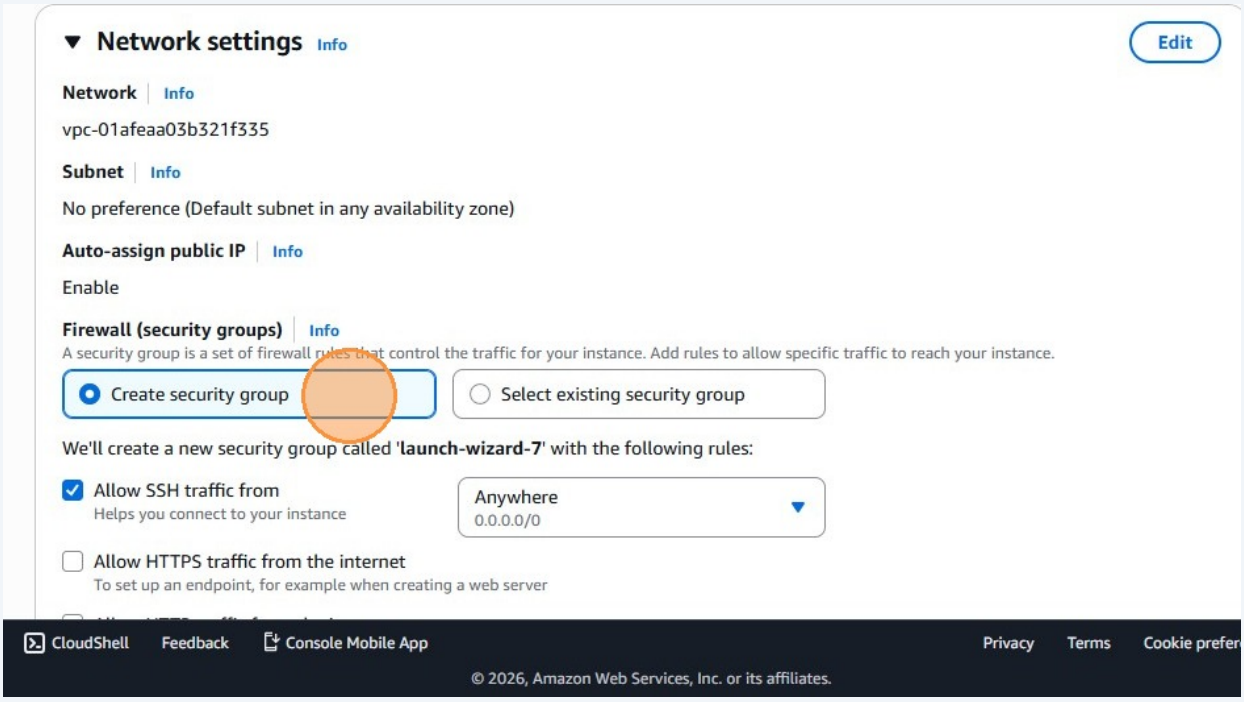
8 Create new Key pairs or select any existing ones you had created earlier on the drowdown icon.



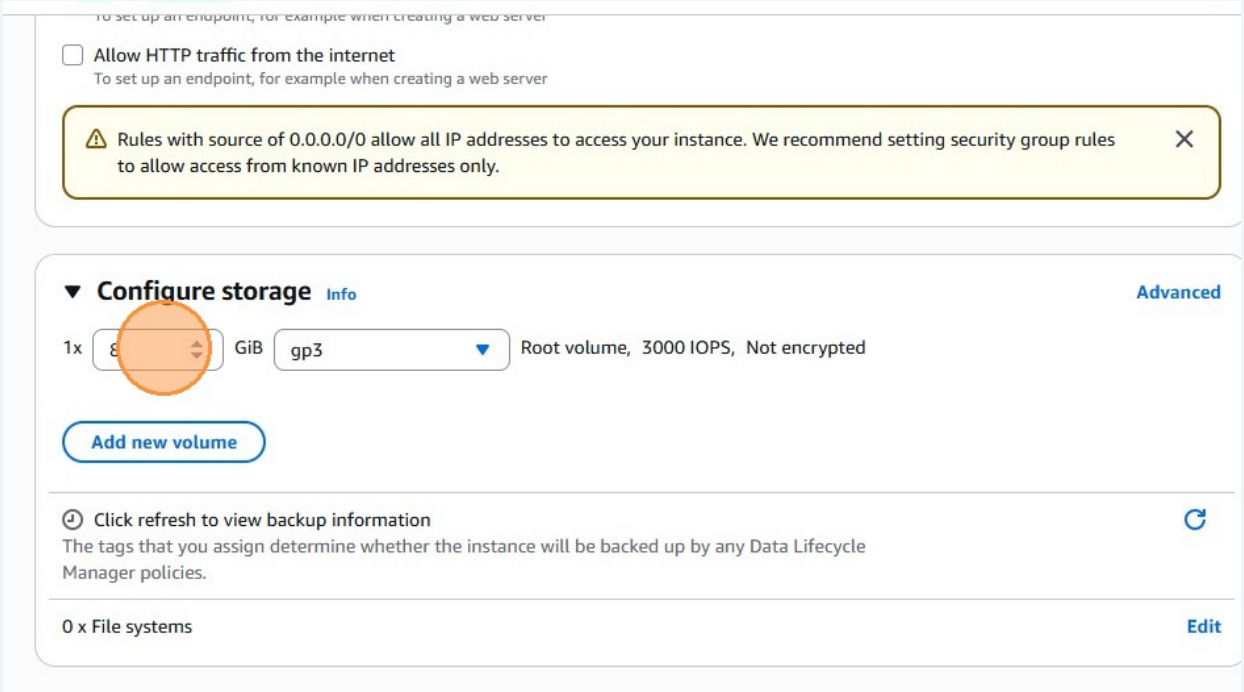
9 I Clicked a key pair I had created earlier "Amazon Server"



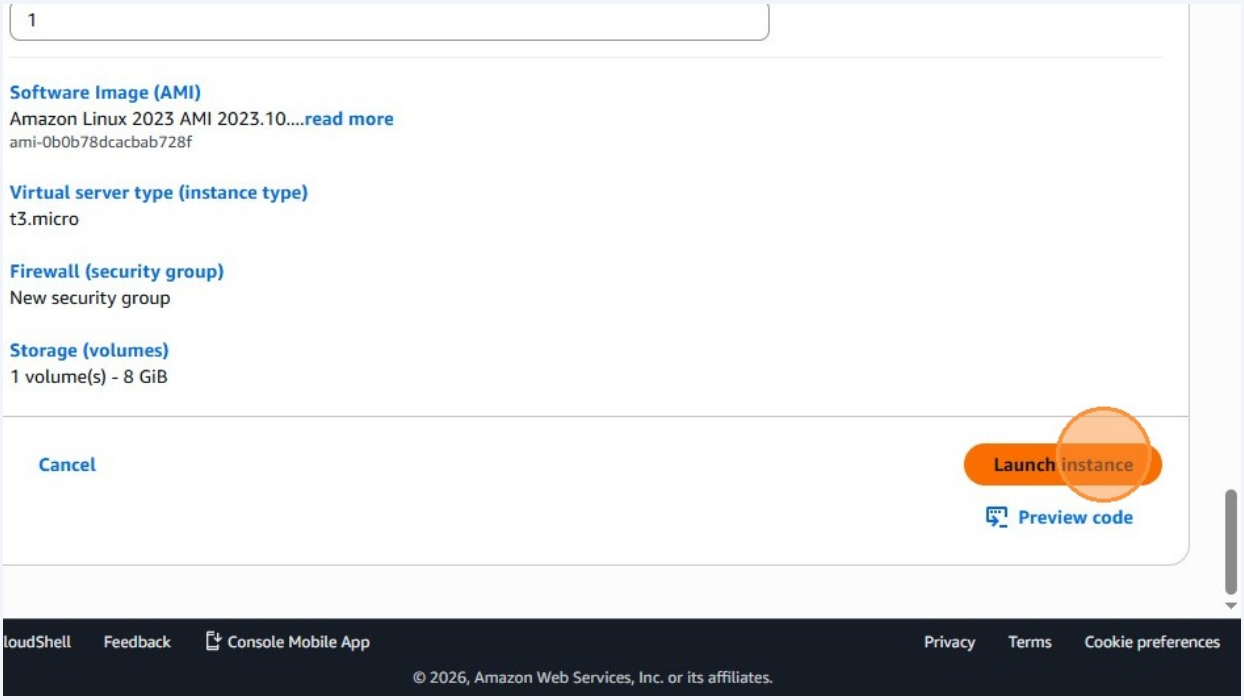
10 Under the Network Settings, you can cofigure the firewall security group or choose the default. "Create security group" is the default option in this case.



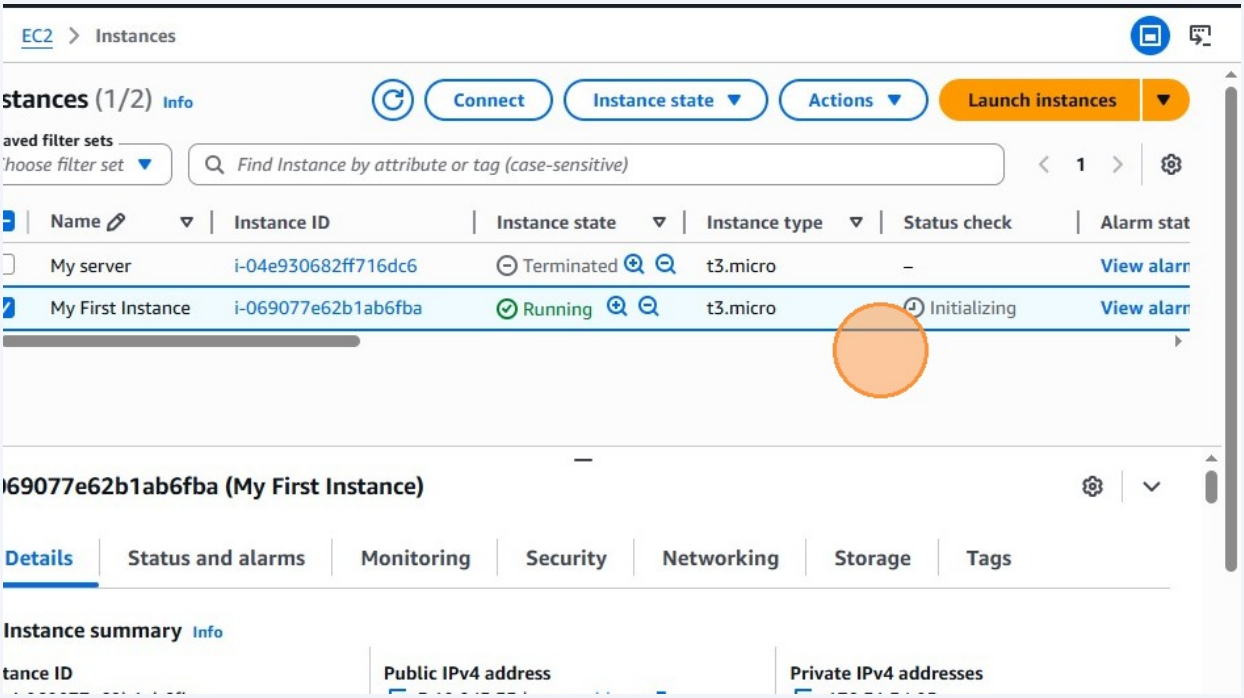
11 Configure the storage capacity of your EC2 instance. We chose the default value of 8GiB as we are not intending on using a lot of storage to run our EC2 instance.



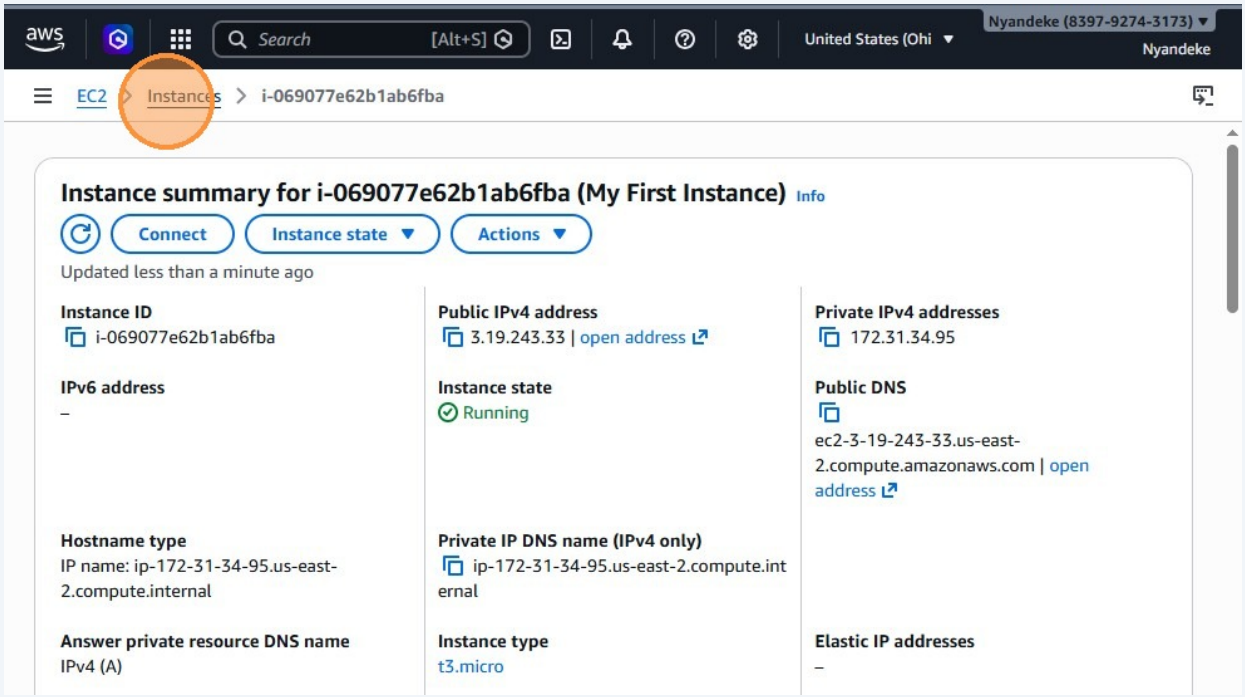
12 Finally click "Launch instance" to create your instance.



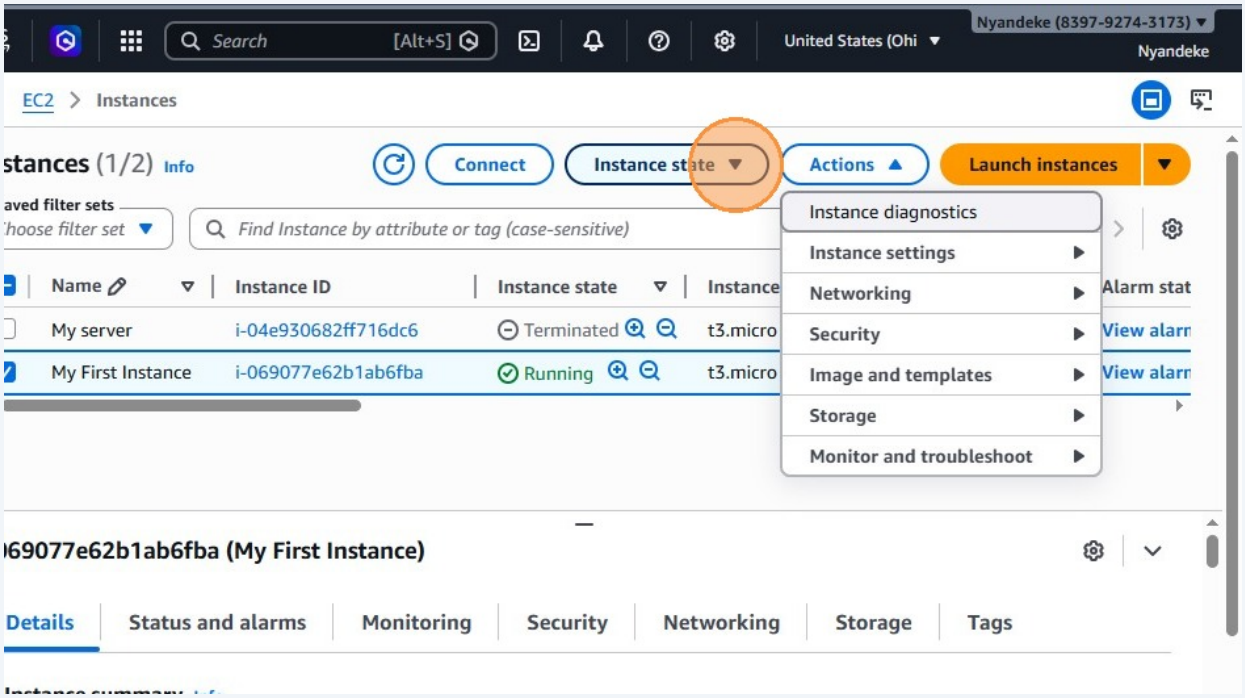
13 Click the "instance ID" to view a summary of your EC2 instance



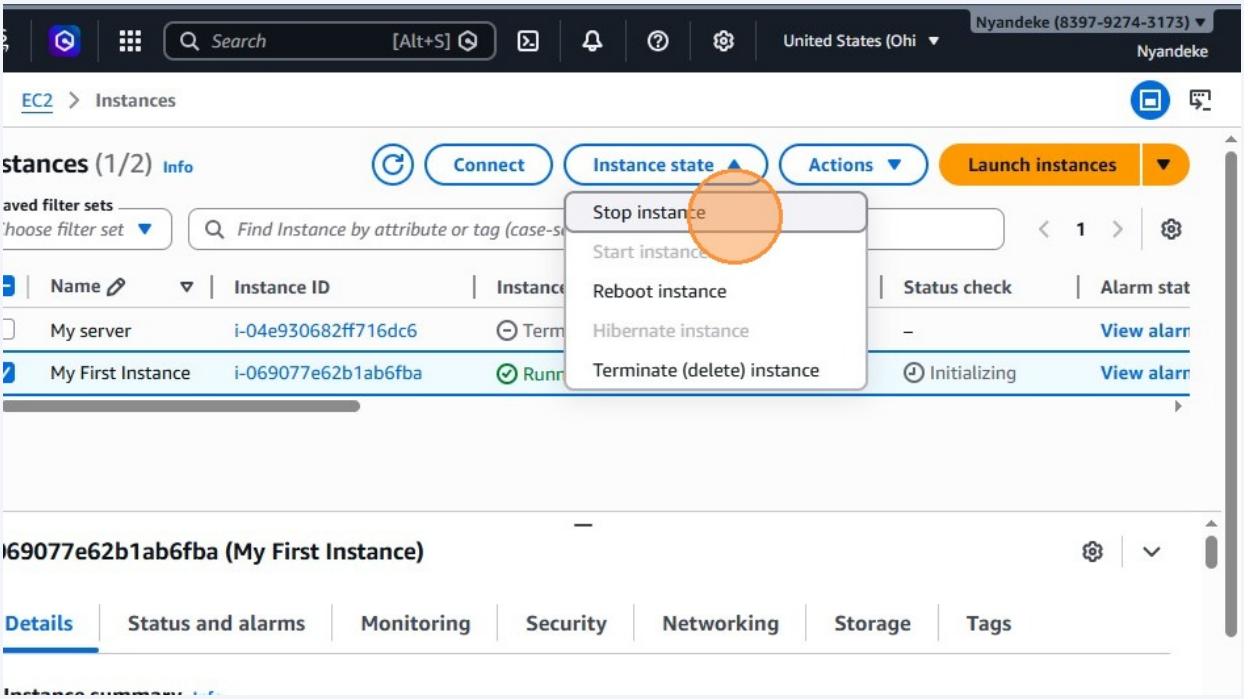
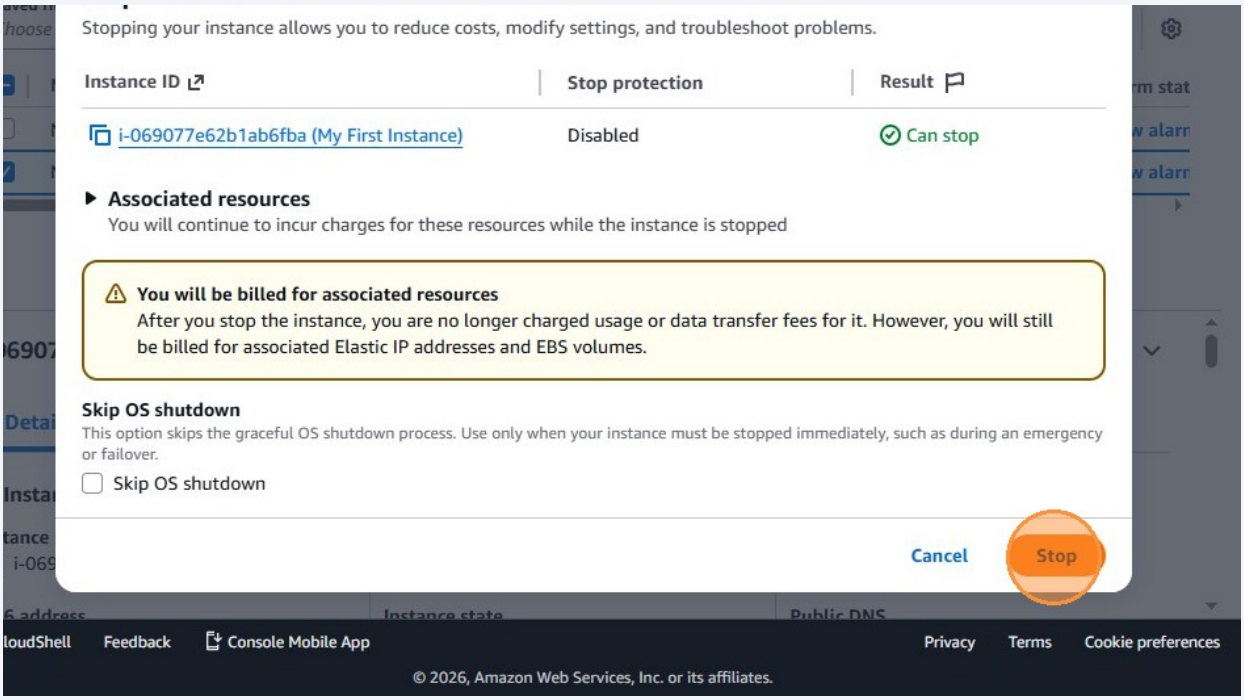
14 Click "Instances" to go back.



15 Click "Actions" to customise the EC2.



16 Click the "Instance state" to "Stop, terminate or reboot instance"



17 We clicked "Stop instance" and we brought to this page, we clicked "Stop" as confirmation. Note the green message stating "can stop" this is because we did not enable "stop protection" which would prevent us from stopping the instance especially during accidental stops.